

AWS Executive Cloud Migration Strategy Guide

A Comprehensive 20–30 Page Executive Framework

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1. Executive Overview

Cloud migration is a strategic business transformation initiative, not just a technology upgrade.

AWS enables agility, scalability, resilience, and innovation through modern cloud-native services.

- Accelerated innovation
- Improved resilience
- Reduced infrastructure overhead
- Elastic scalability
- Enhanced security posture

2. Business Case & ROI

A strong business case aligns migration with financial and strategic goals.

Total Cost of Ownership (TCO) analysis compares on-premises vs AWS environments.

- CapEx to OpEx transition
- Infrastructure cost reduction
- Reduced downtime impact
- Faster time-to-market
- Operational efficiency gains

3. AWS Migration Framework (Assess, Mobilize, Migrate & Modernize)

AWS recommends a phased approach to ensure structured and low-risk transformation.

- Assess: Portfolio discovery and readiness
- Mobilize: Build landing zone and governance
- Migrate & Modernize: Execute waves
- Optimize: Continuous improvement

4. Governance & Operating Model

Define clear roles, responsibilities, and cloud governance standards.

- Cloud Center of Excellence (CCoE)
- Multi-account strategy
- Financial governance (FinOps)
- Security guardrails
- Compliance oversight

5. Security & Compliance Architecture

Security is foundational in AWS and follows the Shared Responsibility Model.

- Identity & Access Management (IAM)
- Network segmentation (VPC design)
- Encryption at rest and in transit
- Logging & monitoring (CloudTrail, CloudWatch)
- Threat detection (GuardDuty, Security Hub)

6. AWS Landing Zone Architecture

A landing zone establishes a secure, scalable multi-account foundation.

- AWS Control Tower setup
- Account structure (Prod, Non-Prod, Shared Services)
- Centralized logging account
- Centralized security account
- Networking baseline

7. Application Portfolio Assessment

Each application is evaluated using the 6 Rs migration strategy.

- Rehost
- Replatform
- Refactor
- Repurchase
- Retire
- Retain

8. Migration Wave Planning

Applications are grouped into waves based on dependencies and business criticality.

- Wave prioritization criteria
- Dependency mapping
- Resource planning
- Downtime window coordination

9. Data Migration Strategy

Data migration must ensure integrity, minimal downtime, and compliance.

- AWS DMS usage
- Schema conversion
- Data validation
- Replication strategies
- Rollback planning

10. DevOps & Automation

Automation accelerates migration and reduces errors.

- Infrastructure as Code (CloudFormation)
- CI/CD pipelines
- Automated testing
- Blue/Green deployments
- Monitoring automation

11. Cutover & Hypercare

Cutover planning ensures seamless production transition.

- Final data sync
- DNS updates (Route 53)
- Smoke testing
- Executive communications
- 30-day hypercare support

12. Cost Optimization & FinOps

Continuous cost governance maximizes ROI.

- AWS Cost Explorer
- Savings Plans & Reserved Instances
- Right-sizing
- Storage tier optimization
- Auto-scaling policies

13. Risk Management

Risk management must be continuous throughout migration.

- Operational risk
- Security risk
- Compliance risk
- Vendor risk
- Business continuity risk

14. Change Management & Communication

Organizational adoption is critical for migration success.

- Stakeholder engagement plan
- Training & enablement
- Executive steering committee
- Communication cadence
- Feedback loops

15. KPIs & Success Metrics

Executive dashboards measure migration effectiveness.

- Application availability
- Cost variance vs forecast
- Deployment frequency
- Mean time to recovery (MTTR)
- Security incident rate

16. Post-Migration Modernization Roadmap

Migration is the beginning of modernization.

- Containerization (EKS/ECS)
- Serverless adoption (Lambda)
- AI/ML integration
- Data lake strategy
- Continuous optimization roadmap